



53 Tips & Ticks



66 Agent 001



68 Know More About

Digital Tools

Enhance

Know Your Camera

There's more to photography than setting your camera to "auto"—photography is an art—in fact it is the brush used by the artist—you

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Photography is much more than setting that brand new camera of yours to "Auto" and going about clicking photos of anything or everything you lay your eyes on. Anyone can do that! Photography is an art—more so the camera is the brush when put in the right hands—yours. You don't have to own a high-end camera to get those jaw-dropping snaps. Digital cameras are tools that need to be explored thoroughly before you can capture those *Vogue* shots.

While fiddling with the camera, as most newbies do, get familiar with all the menus. Start off by using different settings, and taking random shots after varying each setting. Rome wasn't built in a day, and you will not become the greatest photographer over-night. But remember, when those friends of yours

drool over that awesome snap you captured while on that trek or that memorable trip, it's worth every effort! You'll be surprised by some of the results you get from doing this and how better you can get.

Before you actually get out there and buy one, let's brush up on what kind of camera you should go for if you don't own one yet. You can always refer to our Digital Camera test in the October 2007 issue.

The simplest cameras are the point-and-shoot cameras, which make up for the largest chunk of cameras sold. SLRs are generally best for enthusiasts and professionals. When you're selecting a point-and-shoot (P&S) camera, try and have as many manual controls and settings. That way, you have lots of settings to play around with, rather than the camera doing it for you. After all, you and your friends are going to cherish the photos, not the camera!

